5.3 Medicinal plants

Some of the plants around us are good in healing our diseases. We call these plants as **medicinal plants.** They alleviate burns, cut, cold, fever, sneezes and more. Some chemical compounds in the **medicinal plants** act against insects, fungi and certain germs. Medicinal plants are considered as rich resources of ingredients which can be used in drug preparation.

Here is a list of plants that have the highest medicinal value.

Plant name	Parts used	Medicinal use
Amla	Fruit	Cure Vitamin 'C" deficiency diseases like Scurvy. Improve immunity.
Tulsi	Leaves, seed	Cough, cold, bronchitis, expectorant.
Aloe	Leaves	Laxative, wound healing, skin burns and ulcer.
Neem	Bark, leaf and seed	Skin diseases germicide
Turmeric	Rhizome	Helps body to fight foreign invaders,

Activity 3: Ask your parents about the medicinal uses of plants such as Phylanthus, Vallarai, Black nightshade, Tippili, Vettiver, Thuthuvalai and make a write up. What are the other plants used for medicinal purpose in your area?

5.4 Fibre yielding plants

Plants which give us fibres necessary for our uses are called as **Fibre yielding plants.** The fibre from these plants can be spun into thread , rope, and cloth. These fibres are called as natural fibres.

We can classify the Fibre yielding plants into two types based on the uses and the parts of the plant from where we get the fibre.

Based on Use

1. **Textile Fibres** (making cloth), eg: Cotton
2. **Cordage Fibres** (making rope) eg: Coconut Fibre
3. **Filling Fibres** (making mattresses). eg: Silk cotton

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Based on the plant parts

1. **Plant Fibres include seed hairs** eg: cotton;
2. **Stem (or bast) Fibres** eg: flax, jute;
3. **Leaf Fibres** eg: Agave,
4. **Husk Fibres** eg: coconut.



In India, Jute crop is grown in seven states – West Bengal, Assam, Odisha, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Tripura and Meghalaya. West Bengal alone accounts for over 50% of raw jute production.

6th Science_IIIrd Term English Book_Unit_5.indd 71 01-11-2019 5.43.29 PM